Gaungdong export region. Its rival sector, on the other hand, suffered the displacement of various leaders such as Bo Xilai. The conflict is ongoing, but the last Party Congress confirmed the leadership of Xi Jinping and authorised a new round of privatisations. The exporting group resists any distancing of itself from the world economy that might threaten its privileges.

These tensions within the dominant fractions have not altered the defensive geopolitical strategy which characterises the entire Chinese leadership. They seek to assure themselves international access to natural resources, guarantee the security of their conflicted borders (Tibet), and finalise national reconstruction through the reincorporation of Taiwan. In order to achieve these objectives, the elite groups rely on heterogeneous alliances and operate on a fully realpolitik set of policies. This orientation guides its naval guardianship in the Pacific and its intervention into the negotiations over the nuclear arms being built by North Korea. This emphasis on protecting its borders explains its corresponding politico-military absence abroad when compared to its international economic expansion. China inundates the planet with capital and products, but not with armies or covert operatives. It maintains a defensive attitude in the face of periodic harassment by US administrations, building up its surveillance and defensive capabilities.

Beijing's leaders know that the United States dominates the leadership of the imperialist bloc and do not aspire to assume this position. They sense that, no matter to what degree global industry shifts to the East, the Yankee gendarmerie will continue to supervise imperialist interventions. Chinese leaders do not imagine themselves taking over this role under any foreseeable scenario. But China's new status as a global economic power has upset this strategic equilibrium. Its need for natural resources and new markets pushes its leaders to adopt an ever more aggressive posture. Securing raw materials in Africa and signing free trade agreements in Latin America are two examples of this compulsion. There is widespread naivety in the belief that China can avoid capitalism's typical conflicts, returning to a tradition of Eastern pacifism as opposed to Western expansionism.[2]

This new power has joined in the global throng and in its consequent international rivalries. Its export model is not simply a contribution to the market place, nor is it inclusive. It aims to overwhelm competitors in its own Asian sphere. China's rise threatens Japan's central place and South Korea's strength. And tensions are increasing owing to the new giant's growing export of high-value goods and its location of industrial plants in the Asian periphery in order to take advantage of cheap labour costs there.